INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PACKAGING AND PACKING OF CARRELS, DESK TOP, STEEL

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information, It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the packaging, packing, and marking requirements for Steel Desk Top Carrels as covered by Interim Federal Specification AA-C-001917 (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 101 - Preservation, Packaging, Packing Materials: Test Procedures.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

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National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Materials used in the packaging, packing, and marking of the Desk Top Carrels shall be as specified herein and in the applicable specifications.

3.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.1 Levels A and B. Each carrel shall be wrapped, covered or cushioned with nonabrasive material to prevent abrasion and damage when tested as specified. The brackets with mounting instructions and hardware for attaching the carrel to the desk shall be packaged in a box, folder or a bag made of polyethylene film. The dividers shall be taped together and then packaged at the option of the supplier. When the light fixture is not mounted, the light assembly shall be packed in its own container. The shelf, if of the adjustable type, shall be mounted in its normal position on the carrel and secured in place. Alternatively the adjustable shelf shall be wrapped in protective cushioning material or packed in a folder and secured to the stationary shelf.

3.2.2 Level C. Each carrel with component parts shall be prepared for packing to insure adequate protection against abrasion and damage during shipment.

3.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

3.3.1 Level A. Each carrel, packaged as specified in 3.2.1, shall be packed in a tight-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, Grade V3c, Style FOL. Internal packing forms, as specified in 3.3.2, shall be used to secure and immobilize the unit and component parts within the shipping container. The box shall be closed and waterproofed in accordance with method III of the appendix to PPP-B-636. The packed box shall be tested as specified in 4.3.

3.3.2 Level B. Each carrel, packaged as specified in 3.2.1, shall be packed in a tight-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, style FOL, type CF, class domestic, variety optional, grade 275 minimum. Internal shock absorbing packing pads, molded or folded, shall be used to secure the unit in place and to provide not less than 3/4 inch clearance between the carrel and the inside walls of the box. Additional pads or forms shall be used as required to maintain the minimum clearances and to provide the necessary protection for a damage free pack when the packed unit is tested. The component parts of the carrel, packaged as specified in 3.2.1, shall be secured within the pack to prevent movement, metal to metal contact, abrasion and damage during shipment. For handling purposes, there shall be 2 hand holes on each side panel of the shipping container - 1-1/4 inches down from the top and 4 to 5 inches in from the ends (Ref. Figure A). The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636, except that strapping shall not be used as a method of closure. The packed box shall be tested as specified in 4.3.

3.3.3 Level C. Each carrel, packaged as specified in 3.2.2, shall be packed in a box that will assure acceptance and safe delivery in compliance with National Motor Freight Classification Item 83270 or the Uniform Freight Classification Item 44490.

3.4 Material handling provisions.

3.4.1 Palletization. The carrels shall not require palletization, unless otherwise specified (see 6.2).

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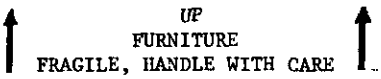
3.5 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 3.5.1 or 3.5.2, as specified (see 6.2).

3.5.1 Civil agencies. Each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

3.5.2 Military activities. Each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

3.5.3 Special marking. In addition to the markings required by 3.5.1 or 3.5.2, each shipping container shall be marked as follows (ref. figure A):

(a) On the side panel:



(b) In an upper corner of both end panels, a standard up arrow.

(c) On the top panel:

TOP
THIS SIDE UP

(d) To facilitate color identification, the front and one end panel of each shipping container shall have an area approximately 3 x 8 inches painted to match the color of the unit packed. Alternatively, adhesive-backed color panels of the size specified above shall be applied to the container.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that the packaging and packing materials used are manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified; or if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. An inspection shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of section 3.

4.2.1 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1.1 Inspection of preparation for delivery. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers offered for acceptance at one time. The inspection level shall be S-4, with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred unit. The supplier shall make available to the inspection team two sets of reference packing assembly drawings along with component packing part drawings to expedite the inspection.

4.2.2 Classification of defects. Defects noted in the inspection shall be scored in accordance with table I.

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TABLE I. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, wrong location.
Materials	Packaging materials not as specified, missing, damaged, or non-serviceable.
Workmanship	Containers inadequately closed, poor application of internal packing parts, moveable or loose parts not secured properly.

4.2.3 Testing.

4.2.3.1 Test report. The tests specified herein are intended to determine compliance with the requirements for level A or B packing and shall be required on one model identical to the item being packed for each level of packing specified in the contract or order. A test report indicating no damage to the test item and no functional damage to the shipping container and packing will be accepted as proof of compliance for the level of packing specified in the contract or order when made available to the inspection service. The test results shall be obtained from tests conducted on an item of the identical model specified in the contract or order. Test results obtained as a result of tests conducted within 12 months prior to date of contract or order, shall contain a complete description of the packaging and packing materials used and items packed. A packed item, tested after date of contract or order, shall be made available for identification by the Government representative and remain at the contractor's plant until the last shipment on the contract is made. This unit shall be used as a guide in determining that packed items furnished in the context of the contract conform to the sample unit tested and accepted. At the option of the Government, tests performed by the manufacturer or a qualified laboratory shall be witnessed by a Government inspector.

4.2.3.2 Testing costs. All costs relating to the tests, including damaged units, shall be at the expense of the contractor or manufacturer.

4.2.3.3 Examination after testing. After the specified tests for levels A or B have been accomplished, a visual examination shall be made of the shipping container and its contents. Any damage to the contents or functional damage to the container or packing shall be cause for rejection. Structural damage to the container, which would result in either loss of the contents or failure of the container in subsequent handling, is cause for rejection. Substantial shifting of contents within the container that would create conditions likely to cause damage during shipment, storage, and reshipment will also be cause for rejection. Minor container damage, such as chipping, abrasion, and superficial slitting of wood members and punctures of container panels, will not be cause for rejection.

4.3 Test methods. The following tests cover procedures for preshipment testing of one packed item for level A or B packing specified in the contract or order. A test cycle in the order herein specified shall consist of all the tests required for a specific shipment.

4.3.1 Incline-impact test. The incline-impact test shall be in accordance with method 5023 of Fed. Test Method No. 101.

4.3.2 Vibration test. The vibration test shall be in accordance with method 5019 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 101. The packed unit shall be placed on the vibration table in the position in which it will be shipped (vertical up-right) and vibrated for 1 hour. At the end of this time, the packed unit shall be horizontally rotated 90 degrees from its original position and vibrated for an additional hour.

4.3.3 Drop test. The drop test (free fall) test shall be in accordance with method 5007 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 101. The drop height shall be 14 inches. The packed unit shall be in its vertical up-right shipping position when the test is applied once to each end of the container. The same test shall be applied to the top of the container by turning the unit over and performing the test.

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4.3.4 Superimposed-load test. The superimposed-load test, with dunnage, shall be used to determine the stackability of the shipping container and inside packing material, to provide sufficient protection to its contents, when subjected to loads imposed by warehouse stacking. The test shall be performed on a compression machine or on a flat rigid floor. The packed unit shall be turned and laid flat on its largest surface. Three pieces of wood dunnage, (1 x 4, 1 x 6 or 2 x 4 material), shall be laid across the top of the container to disperse the weight of the superimposed load over the area of contact and to the sides of the box. One wood dunnage shall be placed 4 inches (± 1") in from each side edge and the third member centered between the two. The prescribed load shall be applied or superimposed equally over the wood dunnage. The test shall be for a period of 1 hour and the prescribed load determined as follows:

$$\text{Stacking load (pounds)} = A \times \frac{(B-C)}{C} \times D$$

Where: A = Weight of loaded container.
B = Allowed stacking height - 15 foot minimum.
C = Height of container (feet).
D = Safety factor - 1.50.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(This section is not applicable to this specification.)

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The requirements of this specification are intended to be used for the packaging, packing, marking and the preshipment performance type testing for steel desk top carrels. The intended application is for low volume products.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Packaging level required (see 3.2).
(c) Packing level required (see 3.3).
(d) Material handling provisions (see 3.4).
(e) Type of marking required (see 3.5).

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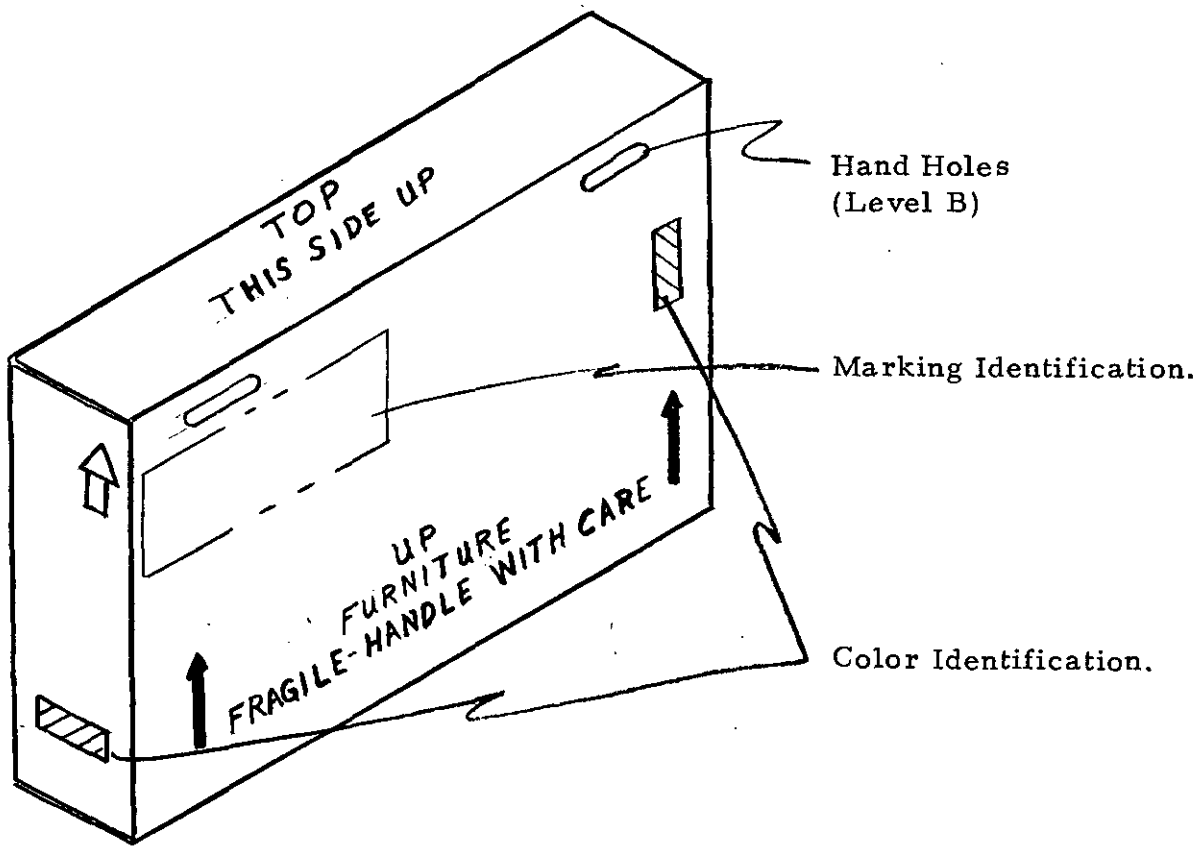


FIGURE A
Special Marking

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